AL-AZHAR UNIVERSITY - GAZA

جامعة الأزهر - غزة

Faculty of Applied Medical Sciences

COURSE SYLLABUS

FUNDAMENTALS OF NURSING (I) – PRACTICAL

Clinical Skills Laboratory

Course Code	NURS2204
Target Audience	BSc of Nursing
Credit Hours	3 Credits
Course Instructor(s):	Dr. Wael S. Mekky

1. Course Introduction

This practical course introduces first year nursing students to the fundamental knowledge, attitudes, and psychomotor skills required for safe, basic nursing care. Through instructor demonstrations, guided practice, simulation, peer learning, and objective structured clinical examinations (OSCEs), students learn to apply principles of patient safety, infection prevention, communication, comfort, privacy, and professional conduct. Students practise essential nursing procedures in a controlled skills-laboratory environment before performing them in clinical settings under appropriate supervision. Emphasis is placed on correct sequencing, standard precautions, accurate documentation, and recognition of situations requiring assistance.

2. General Objective

To develop students' beginning level competence in performing selected fundamental nursing skills safely, systematically, respectfully, and in accordance with institutional policies and current evidence based practice.

3. Specific Objectives

Upon completion of this course, students will be able to:

1. Explain the purpose and basic principles of selected fundamental nursing procedures.
2. Demonstrate effective hand hygiene and appropriate use of personal protective equipment and standard precautions.
3. Identify clients correctly, explain procedures clearly, and protect privacy, dignity, and confidentiality.
4. Perform selected basic nursing skills using the correct sequence, equipment, and safety checks.
5. Measure and report selected vital signs accurately, recognizing and reporting abnormal findings to the instructor or responsible nurse.
6. Assist with basic hygiene, comfort, mobility, admission, transfer, and discharge-related care within the student's level of preparation.
7. Communicate respectfully with clients, families, peers, and healthcare team members during skills practice.

8. Document and report care and findings accurately using approved formats and within the student's scope of practice.
9. Demonstrate accountability, preparedness, professional behaviour, and receptiveness to feedback.
10. Evaluate personal performance, identify learning needs, and improve skills through reflection and repeated practice.

5. Course Content & Practical Skills

Module 1: Fundamental Principles, Admission & Discharge

1. Hand Washing (Medical Asepsis).
2. Admitting a Client (Adult & Pediatric Admission).
3. Patient Transfer (Within Facility or to Outside Agency).
4. Discharging Patients (Discharge Planning & Implementation).

Module 2: Vital Signs Assessment

5. Measuring Body Temperature (Oral, Rectal, Axillary, and Tympanic).
6. Assessing Radial Pulse.
7. Assessing Apical Pulse.
8. Assessing Respirations.
9. Assessing Arterial Blood Pressure (Manual Sphygmomanometer and Stethoscope).
10. Measuring Oxygen Saturation (Pulse Oximetry).

Module 3: Personal Hygiene & Patient Care

11. Bathing a Patient (Bed Bath / Complete Hygiene).
12. Bathing – Disposable Bed Bath, Tub, or Shower.
13. Oral Hygiene (Conscious and Unconscious Patients).
14. Hair Care – Shampooing (Bedbound Patient).
15. Care of a Patient's Environment.

Module 4: Bed Making & Patient Positioning

16. Common Bed Positions & Patient Positioning.
17. Making an Occupied Bed.
18. Making an Unoccupied Bed (Closed & Open Bed).

Module 5: Specimen Collection & Diagnostic Procedures

19. Collecting Urine Specimens (Clean Voided Midstream & Indwelling Catheter).
20. Urine Screening for Glucose, Ketones, Protein, Blood, and pH.
21. Collecting Blood Specimens and Culture by Venipuncture (Syringe & Vacutainer Method).
22. Blood Glucose Monitoring (Capillary Blood Skin Puncture).

Module 6: Advanced Clinical Therapies & Monitoring

23. Obtaining a 12-Lead Electrocardiogram (ECG / EKG).
24. Initiating Blood Therapy (Blood Transfusion Administration).
25. Monitoring for Adverse Blood Transfusion Reactions.

6. Teaching & Learning Strategies

- ❖ Brief interactive explanations and pre-laboratory preparation.
- ❖ Instructor demonstration followed by step by step guided return demonstration.
- ❖ Supervised individual and small group skills practice.
- ❖ Simulation, scenario based learning, and role play.
- ❖ Skills checklists, peer learning, reflective practice, and structured feedback.
- ❖ Formative quizzes and OSCE style practice stations.

7. Course Evaluation & Grading Scheme

The following is a suggested assessment structure. Final weights should be approved by the department and aligned with institutional regulations.

Assessment Component	Suggested Weight	Assessment Focus
Preparation, attendance, and professional conduct	10%	Preparedness, punctuality, participation, safety, and professional behaviour
Formative skills practice and checklists	10%	Performance during guided practice and completion of skill checklists
Written / oral quizzes	10%	Basic principles, rationales, safety, and infection prevention
Midterm practical assessment	30%	Demonstration of selected skills using structured criteria
Final OSCE / practical examination	40%	Integrated performance, critical safety steps, communication, and correct procedure sequence

8. Learning Resources and Equipment:

- Fundamentals of Nursing textbook and approved laboratory procedure manuals.
- Skills laboratory equipment: beds, linens, manikins, vital sign equipment, thermometers, pulse oximeters where available, oxygen delivery equipment, PPE, hand hygiene supplies, and documentation forms.
- Instructor approved skill videos, demonstration materials, checklists, and OSCE station guides.
- Current institutional infection prevention, patient identification, oxygen safety, and documentation policies.

9. Student Responsibilities

- ❖ Attend scheduled laboratory sessions and arrive prepared in the required uniform and with required materials.
- ❖ Review assigned procedures before each session and follow all laboratory safety instructions.
- ❖ Perform skills only within the level taught and under the required supervision; do not independently undertake procedures beyond authorization.

- ❖ Maintain confidentiality, respectful communication, professional boundaries, and patient dignity in all simulations and clinical learning activities.
- ❖ Report equipment problems, exposure incidents, errors, or unsafe conditions immediately to the instructor.
- ❖ Accept feedback, complete remediation when required, and demonstrate progress before final assessment.

10. Laboratory and Safety Policies

Students must follow the institution's policies for infection prevention, hand hygiene, personal protective equipment, safe equipment use, sharps and waste disposal, client identification, privacy, and incident reporting. All procedures must be performed according to instructor direction and approved institutional protocols. Course content and techniques should be reviewed periodically to remain consistent with current standards and local policy.

11. References & Recommended Readings:

1. Potter, P. A., Perry, A. G., Stockert, P. A., & Hall, A. M. (2021). Fundamentals of nursing (10th ed.).
2. Taylor, C., Lynn, P., & Bartlett, J. L. (2019). Fundamentals of nursing: The art and science of person-centered care (9th ed.). Wolters Kluwer.
3. World Health Organization. (2009). WHO guidelines on hand hygiene in health care.
4. World Health Organization. (2016). WHO surgical site infection prevention guidelines.